

Answer Key & Marking Scheme

Subject: Social Science | **Test:** Test 4 (Day 28, 6 June 2026) — 2-Week Cumulative
Maximum Marks: 80

Syllabus: History — The Making of a Global World • Geography — Water Resources • Civics — Federalism; Gender, Religion and Caste • Economics — Sectors of the Indian Economy; Money and Credit

SECTION A — Answer Key (1 mark each)

- Q1.** (a) the Silk Routes.
- Q2.** (b) assembly-line production.
- Q3.** (b) IMF and World Bank.
- Q4.** (c) agriculture.
- Q5.** (c) Narmada.
- Q6.** (c) Kuls or guls.
- Q7.** (b) vertical.
- Q8.** (b) Local self-government.
- Q9.** (d) Caste-mobilisation often shapes campaigns. (Caste is one of many factors but not the only one.)
- Q10.** (b) using religious identity in politics aggressively.
- Q11.** (c) tertiary.
- Q12.** (c) agriculture.
- Q13.** (b) cheque deposit.
- Q14.** (b) 15–20 (typically).
- Q15.** (c) an asset that the borrower owns and pledges to the lender as guarantee.
- Q16.** (a) Bank.
- Q17.** Sex ratio is the number of females per 1000 males in the population.
- Q18.** Public sector — economic activities owned, controlled, financed and managed by the government (e.g. Indian Railways, BHEL, ONGC).
- Q19.** Articles 25-28 (freedom of religion); India having no official religion; equal access to religious places. (Any one.)
- Q20.** A multipurpose river project is one in which the dam serves several purposes simultaneously — irrigation, electricity generation, flood control, water supply, navigation, recreation, etc.

SECTION B — Answer Key (2 marks each)

- Q21.** Feminism is the belief in the political, economic and social equality of the sexes, and the movement organised around this belief. It is relevant in India because of persisting inequalities — gender pay gap, sex-selective abortion, lower literacy among women, and under-representation of women in legislatures and senior positions. (2)
- Q22.** (i) Large-scale displacement of local populations and submergence of forests and farmland. (ii) Disturbance of natural flow, sediment trapping, ecological damage to riverine and downstream ecosystems. (Also: high cost; benefits often go to powerful sections.) (2)
- Q23.** The 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments (1992) made it constitutionally mandatory to hold regular elections to local bodies (Panchayati Raj and urban local bodies), reserved seats for SC/ST/OBC and women, transferred subjects to local bodies, and created independent State Election Commissions. (2)
- Q24.** While the share of GDP from primary sector has fallen and tertiary has risen substantially, employment shares have not changed as fast — over 40% of the workforce is still in agriculture, suggesting low productivity. The transition from primary to secondary/tertiary has been slow because of low industrial absorption and dependence of poor on agriculture. (2)

Q25. The RBI is the central bank that supervises and regulates commercial banks; sets the cash reserve ratio (CRR) and statutory liquidity ratio (SLR); fixes interest rates on borrowing/lending; ensures banks lend to small farmers, small industries and weaker sections; oversees that banks maintain prudent practices. (2)

SECTION C — Answer Key (3 marks each)

Q26. (i) It was the **first industrial-scale war** — fought with machine guns, tanks, aircraft, chemical weapons, mass-produced ammunition. (ii) It was global in **scope** — involving Europe, the colonies (incl. Indian troops), Asia, Africa, the Americas. (iii) **Civilian impact** was unprecedented — long sieges, large casualties, severe economic disruption, women joining factories. (3)

Q27. Water is essential for drinking, sanitation, agriculture, industry and ecological balance. Indian agriculture is the largest user; over-extraction of groundwater has caused depletion. Industries and urban centres add pollution. **Measures:** rainwater harvesting (rooftop, ponds), watershed management, drip and sprinkler irrigation, recycling and treatment of waste water, awareness about water conservation. (3)

Q28. Coming together: independent states unite voluntarily for security and benefits, all units have equal status, central government tends to be less powerful — examples USA, Switzerland, Australia. **Holding together:** a large country divides power between central and state governments to accommodate diversity, central government is generally more powerful — examples India, Spain, Belgium. (3)

Q29. (i) **Religious prejudice** and stereotypes about other religions in everyday life. (ii) **Communal political mobilisation** — using sacred symbols, religious leaders, emotional appeals to mobilise followers. (iii) **Communal violence and riots** — such as the Gujarat riots of 2002 (mentioned in NCERT). (3)

Q30. (i) Basic services (health, education, transport, communication) have expanded. (ii) Rising income demands more financial, retail, hospitality, IT and entertainment services. (iii) The growth of new types of services like IT, business processes, e-commerce — making India a global services hub. As a result, the tertiary sector contributes the largest share to GDP. (3)

Q31. Barter required **double coincidence of wants** — both parties must want what the other has. Money serves as a medium of exchange, eliminating this. Money also acts as a unit of account (price comparison), store of value, and standard of deferred payments. So money makes transactions much more efficient. (3)

SECTION D — Answer Key (5 marks each)

Q32. The Great Depression (1929) began with the US stock market crash. **Global impact:** demand collapsed, prices fell sharply, factories closed, unemployment rose to one-quarter of the workforce in many countries; agricultural prices fell by half; world trade halved between 1929 and 1932; banks failed in many countries; gold standard was abandoned. **Indian impact:** exports and imports nearly halved; agricultural prices fell by half; rural debt grew (peasants had to sell jewellery and land to pay taxes/rent); urban Indians and businesses with fixed incomes benefited as prices fell. The economic distress strengthened the Civil Disobedience Movement. (5)

Q33. Problems: (i) Uneven distribution — abundant in some areas, scarce in others. (ii) Over-extraction of groundwater leading to falling water tables. (iii) Pollution of rivers and lakes by industrial and domestic waste. (iv) Climate change altering rainfall patterns. (v) Conflict over water sharing between states. **Steps:** (i) Construction of dams and multipurpose projects (with safeguards). (ii) Rainwater harvesting (rooftop, traditional systems like khadins, kuls, tankas, bamboo drip irrigation). (iii) Watershed management. (iv) Reuse and recycling. (v) Public awareness; pricing of water; legal frameworks like the National Water Policy. (5)

Q34. Gender inequalities in India: lower female literacy (~65% women vs ~80% men), low workforce participation (~25% women), wage gap, sex-selective abortion, under-representation in legislature, domestic violence. **Constitutional/legal provisions:** (i) Article 14 (equality before law) and Article 15 (no discrimination on the basis of sex). (ii) Article 39 — equal pay for equal work. (iii) The Equal Remuneration Act 1976; Maternity Benefit Act; Domestic Violence Act 2005; legal age of marriage 18 for women. (iv) Reservation of one-third seats in local bodies. **Social reforms:** Beti Bachao Beti Padhao; campaigns against dowry and female foeticide. Despite these, gaps remain — needing both legal reform and changes in social attitudes. (5)

Q35. Formal sources include banks and cooperatives — they charge moderate interest rates, are regulated by RBI, and require documentation/collateral. **Informal sources** include moneylenders, traders, employers, friends and relatives — interest rates are very high (sometimes 36% or more); no regulation; often involve

manipulation and exploitation. **Why rural poor depend on informal sources:** banks insist on collateral and paperwork; loans for emergencies, festivals or marriages aren't always provided by banks; remoteness from banks; small loan sizes are unattractive for banks; trust on local moneylenders. **Role of SHGs:** Self-Help Groups (typically 15–20 women in a village) pool small savings, lend to members at lower rates, build creditworthiness; banks often lend to the SHG as a whole; reduce dependence on moneylenders; empower women economically. (5)

SECTION E — Answer Key (4 marks each)

Q36. (i) Any one of: cotton, wheat, beef, rubber, tea, opium. (1) (ii) Mainly from densely populated regions of Asia (esp. China and India) and Europe — to plantations in the Caribbean, Mauritius, Fiji, the Americas, etc. Indentured Indian labour was a key example. (1) (iii) Capital movement (long-term financial loans and investments) financed railways, plantations, mines, factories worldwide; tied debtor countries to lenders (mainly Britain); helped integrate the world economy but also created dependencies and vulnerability to shocks (as later seen in 1929). (2)

Q37. (i) The state has no religion of its own — equal respect to all religions; freedom to follow any religion; right to equality regardless of religion. (1) (ii) Any two: (a) no official state religion; (b) Articles 25-28 — freedom of religion; (c) Article 15 — no discrimination on the basis of religion; (d) Right to manage religious institutions. (2) (iii) Some religious practices contradict equality (e.g. untouchability, gender discrimination). The state intervenes through laws (e.g. abolition of untouchability, age of marriage) to protect citizens' rights and ensure equality within communities. (1)

Q38. (i) Banks demand collateral and paperwork; rural poor often lack these. They also need small loans quickly for emergencies/agricultural inputs/marriages, which formal sources may not provide easily. (1) (ii) (a) Very high interest rates (36% or more) leading to debt traps. (b) No regulation — manipulation by lenders; loss of land/property pledged. (c) Insecurity and exploitation. (Any two.) (2) (iii) SHGs provide a platform — savings of members are pooled and lent at low interest to members; the group's creditworthiness allows access to bank credit at reasonable rates; reduces dependence on moneylenders; empowers women. (1)

— End of Answer Key —